



A G A P A Y

LOVE HOW YOU GIVE

PARISH ONBOARDING & OPERATIONS GUIDE

The *Accounting Suite* for Parish Treasurers

A complete, practical guide to recording income, paying bills, tracking designated and restricted funds, closing the books each month, and reading your reports.

RECORD	Income from any source — cash, checks, deposits — in plain language
PAY	Vendor bills, with approval and check printing built in
TRACK	Every fund, kept where you already manage it in Funds & Alms
CLOSE	The month, with reconciliation and a required note on any difference
GROW	Into the full ledger and Accountant view whenever your parish is ready

Prepared for Orthodox parishes and monasteries using AGAPAY

OVERVIEW

Two Ways to Work, One Set of Books

Every entry you make — however you make it — lands in the same correct, auditable ledger underneath. Choose the view that matches how your parish works today.

DEFAULT VIEW

Treasurer view

Plain-language forms for the two things you'll do most: record what came in, and pay what's owed.

- Record Income & Pay a Bill, front and center
- Your activity, described in plain sentences
- No debits, no credits, ever shown

AVAILABLE ANYTIME

Accountant view

The full ledger — journal entries, adjusting entries, period close, budgets, and governance.

- Full journal entry & close-period workflow
- Budgets, forecasts, and variance reports
- One click away from Treasurer view, always

NOTE

One toggle, one login. Switching views never hides or changes your data — it only changes what you're shown.

What You'll Need to Get Started

Item	What to Have Ready
Chart of accounts	Already seeded for you — a parish-appropriate starting set of accounts, ready on day one.
Funds	Configured once in Funds & Alms, then available automatically in the Accounting Suite.
Vendors	Added as you enter your first bills — name, and a default expense account if you'd like one.
Bank account	Connected for reconciliation, so statement imports can be matched each month.
Staff access	A treasurer or bookkeeper login, or a shared PIN profile for in-office use.

PART 1 · TREASURER VIEW

Record Income

For any gift that doesn't already flow in through My AGAPAY giving — cash, checks, a fundraiser deposit. Four questions, and the double-entry happens correctly behind the scenes.

- 1 Where did the money go?**
Choose the bank or cash account you deposited it into.
- 2 What kind of income was it?**
Stewardship & Tithes, General Donations, Candle Offerings, Commemorations, Bookstore Sales — named in the parish's own language.
- 3 Which fund?**
General, building, or any restricted fund your parish tracks — the same funds you already manage in Funds & Alms.
- 4 Amount, date, and a short description.**
Save, and it's posted — correctly, immediately, and fully reflected in every report.

IMPORTANT

You'll never see the words "debit" or "credit" in this flow. The balanced entry is built for you, every time — there's nothing to get wrong.

Choosing an Income Type

Income Type	Typical Use
Stewardship & Tithes	Regular giving and stewardship commitments from parishioners.
General Donations	One-time gifts not tied to a specific campaign or purpose.
Candle Offerings	Offerings received at candle stands.
Commemorations	Gifts given for the commemoration of the living and departed.
Bookstore Sales	Recorded automatically when a Bookstore sale completes — see Part 4.

Splitting a Deposit Across Funds **NEW**

A single collection basket rarely holds just one kind of gift. When it doesn't, add as many rows as you need — each with its own income type, fund, and amount — and AGAPAY keeps the whole deposit balanced automatically as you go.

PART 2 · TREASURER VIEW **NEW**

Recording a Non-Cash Gift

A donated cross, a parish vehicle, a load of building materials — no money changed hands, but the gift still belongs on your books. This is a different kind of entry from a deposit, built specifically for that.

1 What was received?

A short description of the item or service — this is what shows on your reports and in your records.

2 How was the value determined?

An appraisal, a comparable retail listing, or the donor's own stated value. This is required — it's how a gift's value is documented, not just recorded.

3 Which account should reflect it?

An expense account if it's used right away, or an asset account if it's a capital item being added to the parish's books.

4 Fund, amount, and date.

Save, and a correctly balanced entry posts — with nothing touching your bank account, because nothing was deposited.

NOTE

Non-cash gifts post to their own dedicated income line, kept separate from cash contributions on your Statement of Activities — the standard your accountant expects for this kind of gift.

TIP

Recording who gave a non-cash gift is optional, kept for your own records — it doesn't create a pledge or a receivable, just a memo alongside the entry.

PART 3 · TREASURER VIEW

Pay a Bill

From the vendor invoice on your desk to a printed check or an online payment — with an approval step built in, so no bill goes out unreviewed.

The Bill-to-Payment Flow

Step	What Happens
Enter the bill	Vendor, invoice number, due date, expense account, fund, and amount. Save active vendors once and reuse them every time.
Approve it	A second set of eyes confirms the bill before it's paid — a simple, built-in control for parishes that want one.
Pay it	Print a check, pay by ACH, or record a payment made another way. Pay several bills at once with a payment run.
Print, if by check	Reprinting is clearly marked. A voided payment can never be printed again. Check numbers are never issued twice.

TIP

Recurring bills — rent, utilities, a standing subscription — can be scheduled once and reviewed each time they come due, instead of re-entered from scratch.

PART 4 · TREASURER VIEW

Payment Runs, Checks & Vendor 1099s

Paying twelve vendors shouldn't mean printing twelve checks one at a time. And when a vendor crosses the federal reporting threshold, AGAPAY already knows.

Paying Several Bills at Once

- 1 Select a bank account and the bills to pay**
Choose from any approved, unpaid bills across one or more vendors.
- 2 Review the run**
See the exact check-number range that will be used before you commit to anything.
- 3 Post, then print once**
One trip to the printer, one stack of checks — not one bill at a time.

IMPORTANT

Check numbers are reserved atomically, so two payment runs started at the same time can never be issued the same check number.

What Keeps a Check Safe to Print

Protection	What It Does
Reprint banner	Printing the same check a second time is always clearly marked "reprint" on the page.
Void blocks printing	A voided payment can never be printed again, by anyone.
No duplicate numbers	A check number, once used, is never issued to another payment.

Vendor 1099 Review

Vendors marked for 1099 review are totaled automatically each year. Card and debit payments are excluded from the total — the card network reports those on its own 1099-K, so including them here would double-report the same income.

TIP

The \$600 federal threshold is shown for every marked vendor, even those still under it — so you can see who's close, not just who's already crossed it. This is a data-preparation aid, not a filed 1099 — your accountant still handles the actual filing.

PART 5 · KEEPING MONEY SEPARATED

Funds, Kept Where You Already Manage Them

Your fund list lives in one place — the Funds & Alms tab of your parish dashboard — and flows into the Accounting Suite automatically. There's nothing to keep in sync by hand.

Restriction Type	Meaning
Unrestricted	Your general operating fund — free to use as parish leadership decides.
Board-designated	Set aside by parish council decision, not by a donor's stipulation — a distinction your reports keep visible.
Donor-restricted, temporary	Given for a specific purpose — a building project, a mission trip — until that purpose is fulfilled.
Donor-restricted, permanent	An endowment-style gift, where the principal is preserved by the donor's own terms.

NOTE

Add or rename a fund in Funds & Alms, and it's ready to use in the Accounting Suite the moment you save — no separate setup step.

Bookstore & Parish Commerce

Bookstore sales post to the ledger automatically — item, quantity, and inventory are tracked, and cost of goods sold is calculated for you, so a sale is never just a number with no record behind it.

PART 6 · UNDERSTANDING YOUR STANDING

Reports That Answer a Real Question

Every report below draws on the same live ledger – there's no separate export to reconcile, no spreadsheet to keep current by hand.

Report	What It Tells You
Statement of Activities	What came in, what went out, and the change in your parish's position – for any period you choose.
Statement of Financial Position	What the parish owns, owes, and retains, as of any date – the parish's balance sheet.
Fund Activity	Beginning balance, activity, and ending balance for every fund, side by side.
Statement of Cash Flows	Where cash actually moved, reconciled to the real change in your bank balance.
Statement of Functional Expenses	Program, management, and general spending, broken out by category – built for your annual filing.
Net Asset Rollforward	How each fund's restriction class changed over the period.
Trial Balance	Every account, every balance – the accountant's starting point for a deeper review.
NOTE	Most reports can show a comparison column against a prior period – this year's Advent giving next to last year's, side by side, without running the report twice.

PART 7 · PLANNING AHEAD

Budgets

Set what the parish expects to raise and spend for the year, then watch how actual results compare — month by month, account by account.

Building a Budget

- 1 Create the budget and add lines**
One line per account and fund — expected income, expected expense, for the fiscal year.
- 2 Submit and approve**
A second reviewer confirms the budget before it's locked — the same review discipline as a bill approval.
- 3 Lock it**
A locked budget becomes the fixed comparison point for the year — copy it forward to start next year's budget quickly.

Reading a Budget Against Reality

Tool	What It Shows
Budget vs. Actual	Every line, budgeted against what's actually posted so far — over or under, at a glance.
Forecast	Where the year is likely to land if current trends continue.
Council Budget Packet	A print-ready summary built for a parish council meeting — no separate slide deck to assemble.

NOTE If your parish tracks pledges in My AGAPAY, the pledge total for the year can be compared directly against your stewardship revenue budget line — a real number to plan against, not a guess.

PART 8 · MONTHLY DISCIPLINE

Closing the Books Each Month

Upload your bank statement, and AGAPAY suggests matches against what's already recorded — you confirm, adjust anything that's off, and close the month with confidence.

1 Reconcile

Import your bank statement; matched transactions are confirmed automatically, and anything unmatched is flagged for a quick look.

2 Explain any difference

If your books and your bank statement don't agree to the penny, a short note is required before you can close — so nothing gets closed by accident.

3 Close the month

Once closed, that period is locked — a clean, auditable line your parish council or accountant can always trust.

IMPORTANT

A month cannot be closed with an unexplained difference. This is enforced by the system, not left to memory — it's the safeguard that keeps your books honest.

PART 9 · ACCOUNTANT VIEW

The Full Ledger, When You Need It

Everything in Treasurer view rests on real double-entry bookkeeping underneath. Accountant view is that ledger, directly — for a bookkeeper, a CPA, or a treasurer whose parish has outgrown the plain-language forms.

What's Here That Isn't in Treasurer View

Tool	What It's For
Journal entries	Enter, validate, and post a custom multi-line entry directly — for anything that doesn't fit a simple deposit or bill.
Reverse & void	Undo a posted entry cleanly, with a reason recorded — the original entry is never edited or deleted.
Adjusting entries	Formal, reviewable corrections at period end — the kind an outside accountant typically proposes.
Opening balances	Set a parish's starting position when it first begins using the Accounting Suite, or when migrating from another system.
Chart of accounts	Add, edit, or archive accounts directly — archiving is blocked if the account still has open activity.

NOTE

Every posted journal entry — however it was created — is permanent. Corrections happen by reversing or adjusting, never by rewriting history. This is what makes your books auditable.

Attachments

A bill, a journal entry, or a bank reconciliation can each carry supporting documents — a scanned receipt, an invoice, a bank statement. Once attached, a document travels with its record permanently.

PART 10 · ONCE A YEAR

Closing the Year

Monthly close keeps each period honest as you go. Year-end close is a separate, larger step – the one that puts a fiscal year fully to rest.

Monthly Close vs. Year-End Close

	Monthly Close	Year-End Close
How often	Every month	Once, at fiscal year end
What it locks	One month's transactions	The entire fiscal year, and every month within it
Net-asset effect	None	Rolls the year's activity into the parish's retained net assets

Archiving the Year

1 Every month is closed first

A fiscal year can't be archived while any month inside it is still open.

2 Archive the fiscal year

This is a distinct, deliberate action – not something that happens automatically when the calendar turns over.

3 The year is now historical

Reports still read it perfectly; nothing further can post into it.

IMPORTANT

Reopening an archived year requires a stated reason and elevated permission – this is intentionally not a casual action. If a genuine correction is needed after archival, it's still possible, but it's meant to be rare.

PART 11 · WHO CAN DO WHAT

Roles & Access

Access is granted by what someone needs to do, not all-or-nothing – a volunteer can help with bookkeeping without holding the keys to everything.

Role	Typical Access
Treasurer	Full day-to-day access, including the highest-trust actions – closing periods, opening balances, and migration.
Bookkeeper	Everyday entry and review – bills, deposits, reconciliation – without the small set of most sensitive actions.
Staff PIN profile	A shared login for in-office use, scoped to exactly the tasks that profile needs.

NOTE

Every action in the Accounting Suite is recorded – who did it, and when. This isn't a setting to configure; it's simply how the ledger works.

Moving From QuickBooks or Aplos

1 Chart of accounts

Import from a CSV export – matched against your existing accounts where possible, created fresh where needed.

2 Vendors and funds

Brought over the same way, with funds mapped to what you already manage in Funds & Alms.

3 Starting balances

Most parishes start clean with an opening trial balance as of a cutover date – your old system stays available for historical lookup.

TIP

A full transaction-history import is also available for parishes that want continuous detail, not just a clean starting point – ask AGAPAY support if that's the right fit for your parish.